

Ni/Zeolite-Y 촉매 기반 Polypropylene 고압 열분해 수소 생산

Hydrogen Production via High-Pressure Pyrolysis of Polypropylene Using Ni-Supported Zeolite Y Catalyst

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2025. 05.22.

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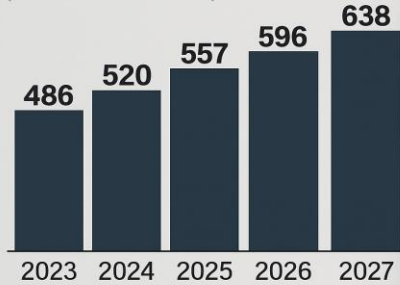
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GLOBAL WASTE PLASTIC MARKET FORECAST

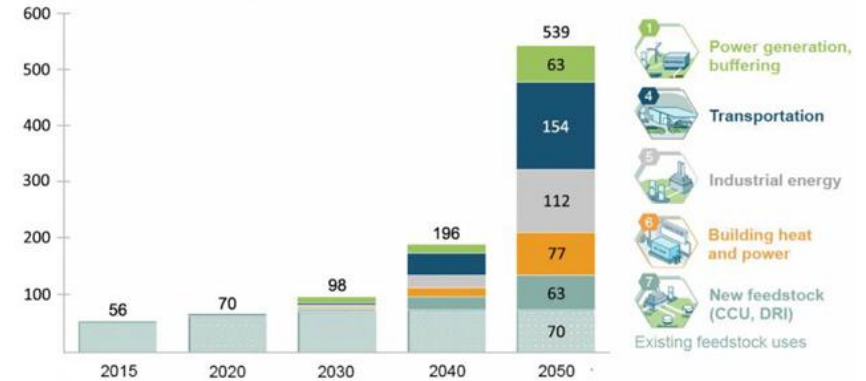
(Unit: billion dollars)



Source: PwC

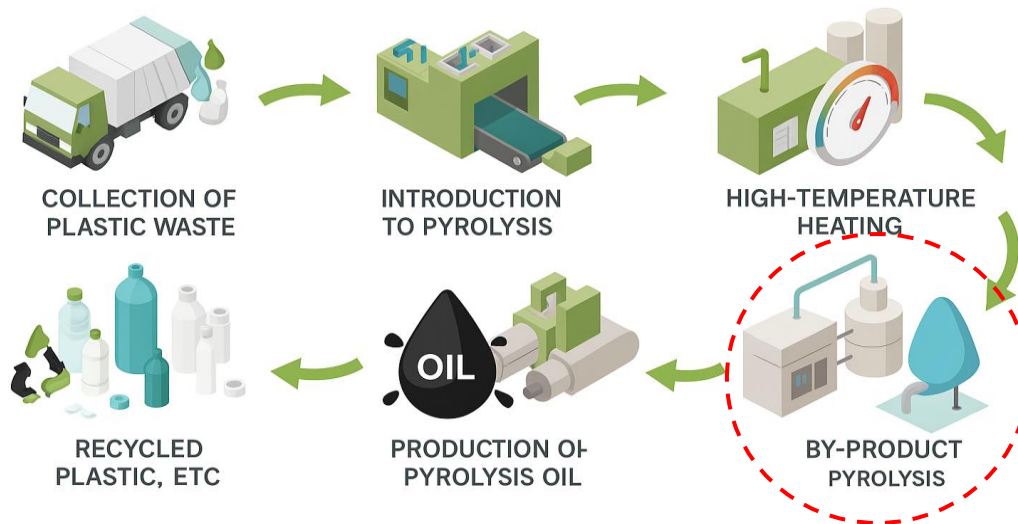
Hydrogen demand could increase 10-fold by 2050

Demand in million metric tonnes H₂



Adapted from *Scaling Up*, Hydrogen Council, 2017. Original units in EJ converted to tonnes H₂; 1 EJ = 7,000,000 tonnes H₂.

PLASTIC PYROLYSIS PRODUCTION PROCESS



Characteristics of plastic and catalyst

Ref. A review on catalytic pyrolysis of plastic wastes to high-value products., P.Yujie, *Energy Conversion Management*, 2022

Product distributions in the pyrolysis of different plastics.

Reference	Feedstock	Catalyst	Condition*	Yields (wt.%)	
				Gas	Oil
[37]	HDPE	None	T = 650 °C Time = 0.8 s	20.3	–
			T = 650 °C Time = 1.5 s	31.5	–
[23]	PP	None	T = 746 °C	65.9	29.6
[23]	PE	None	T = 728 °C	59.3	38.2

- Selection of **polypropylene** through comparative analysis

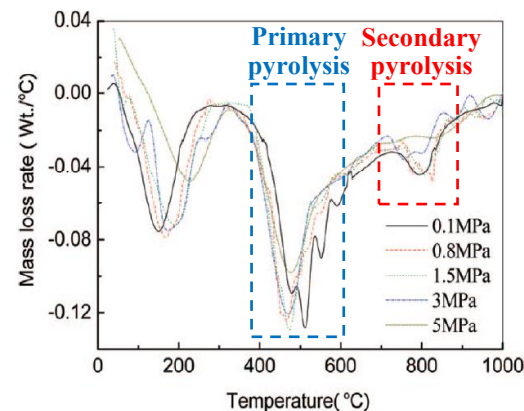
Product distributions obtained by different authors in the pyrolysis with different catalysts.

Reference	Feedstock	Catalyst	Condition	Yields (wt.%)	
				Gas	Oil
[74]	LDPE	ZSM-5	T ₁ = 480 °C T ₂ = 375 °C	72.73	24.94
[75]	HDPE	Y zeolite	T = 450 °C Time = 30 min	71.5	27
[70]	HDPE	HZSM-5	T = 500 °C	57	41.94
		H β	Time = 15 h	36	30.8
		HY		–	–
[81]	PP	HZSM-5	T = 360 °C	94.77	2.31
		HUSY		89.49	3.75
		HMOR		88.29	4.54
[84]	HDPE	SBA-16	T = 430 °C	6.3	43.3
		Al-SBA-16	Time = 2 h	20.6	75.8

- Verification of increased gas emission at lower temperatures due to catalytic effects

Primary pyrolysis and secondary pyrolysis

Ref. Influence of pressure on coal pyrolysis and char gasification, H. Yang, *Energy&Fuels*, 2007



DTG curves of pyrolysis under different pressures

• Primary Pyrolysis (400-700°C)

- Production of CO, CO₂, CH₄, H₂O through organic reactions
- **Inhibition** of volatile matter release due to high pressure conditions

• Secondary Pyrolysis (over 700°C)

- Production of H₂ and CO through internal tar cracking
- Increased residence time of volatile matter due to high pressure conditions
- **Enhanced** hydrocarbon cracking and gas production promotion

H₂ production with Ni/zeolite-Y catalyst

Ref. Co-production of hydrogen and carbon nanofibers ...,
M,d.Nasir Uddin, *Energy Conversion and Management*, 2015

Results from methane decomposition over Ni/Zeolite-Y

No.	T(°C)	Initial H ₂ (%)	Initial CH ₄ (%)	No.	T(°C)	Initial H ₂ (%)	Initial CH ₄ (%)
15% Ni-supported Y zeolite catalyst				30% Ni-supported Y zeolite catalyst			
1	500	19.09	10.52	1	500	18.08	9.91
2	550	30.27	17.73	2	550	34.85	20.82
3	600	36.32	22.11	3	600	48.85	31.57
4	650	41.02	25.76	4	650	58.58	41.67

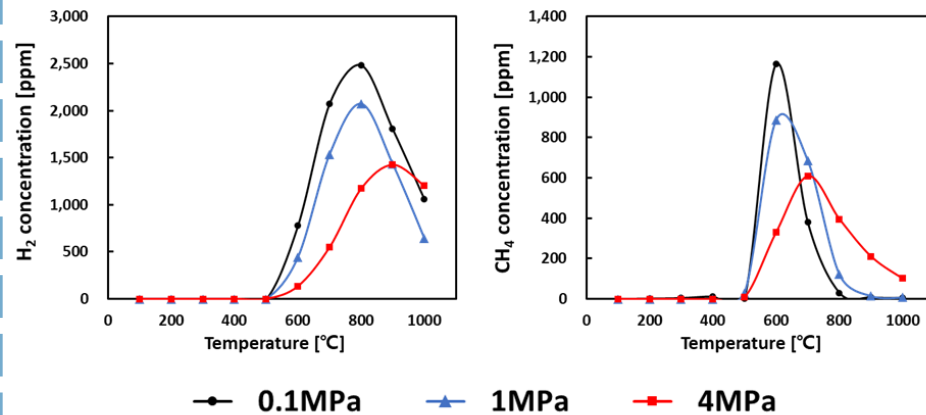
Behavior of AC (Accumulated carbon) with total methane conversion

No.	T(°C)	Total methane conversion(mol/g _{cat})	No.	T(°C)	Total methane conversion(mol/g _{cat})
15% Ni-supported Y zeolite catalyst			15% Ni-supported Y zeolite catalyst		
1	500	197.08	1	500	482.56
2	550	526.40	2	550	1047.30
3	600	586.21	3	600	1242.54
4	650	405.47	4	650	821.67

- Increased H₂ and CH₄ production with temperature rise
- H₂ with 15% Ni/zeolite-Y < H₂ with 30% Ni/zeolite-Y
- Decreased total methane conversion relative to AC

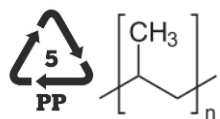
H₂, CH₄ production and methanation

Ref. Effect of high-pressure pyrolysis on syngas and char structure of petroleum coke, Hyeong-Bin Moon, Chung-Hwan Jeon, *Energy*, 2024

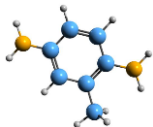


Variations in gas concentration as a function of temperature and pressure

- H₂ concentration
 - Production peaks shift to higher temperatures increasing pressure
 - H₂ decreases due to methanation under high pressure
(methanation : $C + 2H_2 \rightarrow CH_4$)
- CH₄ concentration
 - At 0.1MPa, CH₄ peaks at 600°C then rapidly declines
 - Higher CH₄ observed above 700°C under high pressure



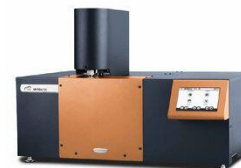
Waste plastic



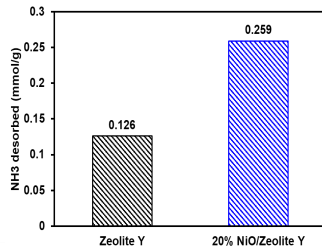
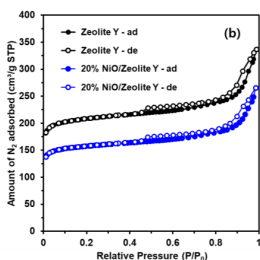
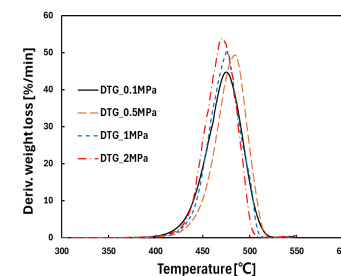
Catalyst

Pyrolysis

Pyrolysis characteristics
under **high-pressure**



HP-TGA



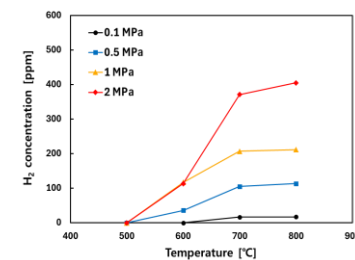
Catalyst characteristics

Gas analysis

Syngas composition
(H₂, CH₄, CO, CO₂)



Gas chromatography



Optimization H₂

- Catalytic pyrolysis under high pressure & temperature conditions
- Thermogravimetric analysis and gas conversion
- Analysis of catalytic effects on gas concentration
- Maximization **hydrogen production**

Pressurized TGA



HP TGA 75

- High pressure pyrolysis of polypropylene
- Analysis of weight loss under different pressure
- Analysis of the effects of pressure on primary pyrolysis and secondary pyrolysis

Experimental conditions

Temperature	10°C/min to 800°C
Pressure	0.1 MPa, 0.5 MPa, 1 MPa, 2 MPa
Purge gas	N ₂ gas, 30ml/min

Gas chromatography



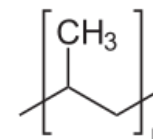
YL 6500 GC

- Analysis of syngas after high pressure pyrolysis
- Using standard gas (H₂, CO, CO₂, CH₄ each 1%, N₂ balance)
- Using TCD and FID

Experimental conditions

Temperature	120°C
Measurement Interval	10 min
TCD	H ₂
FID	CO, CO ₂ , CH ₄

Sample

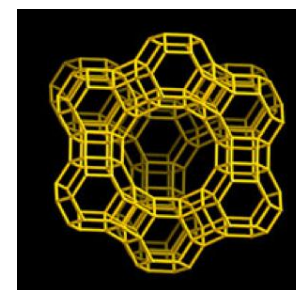


Polypropylene pellet

Sample conditions

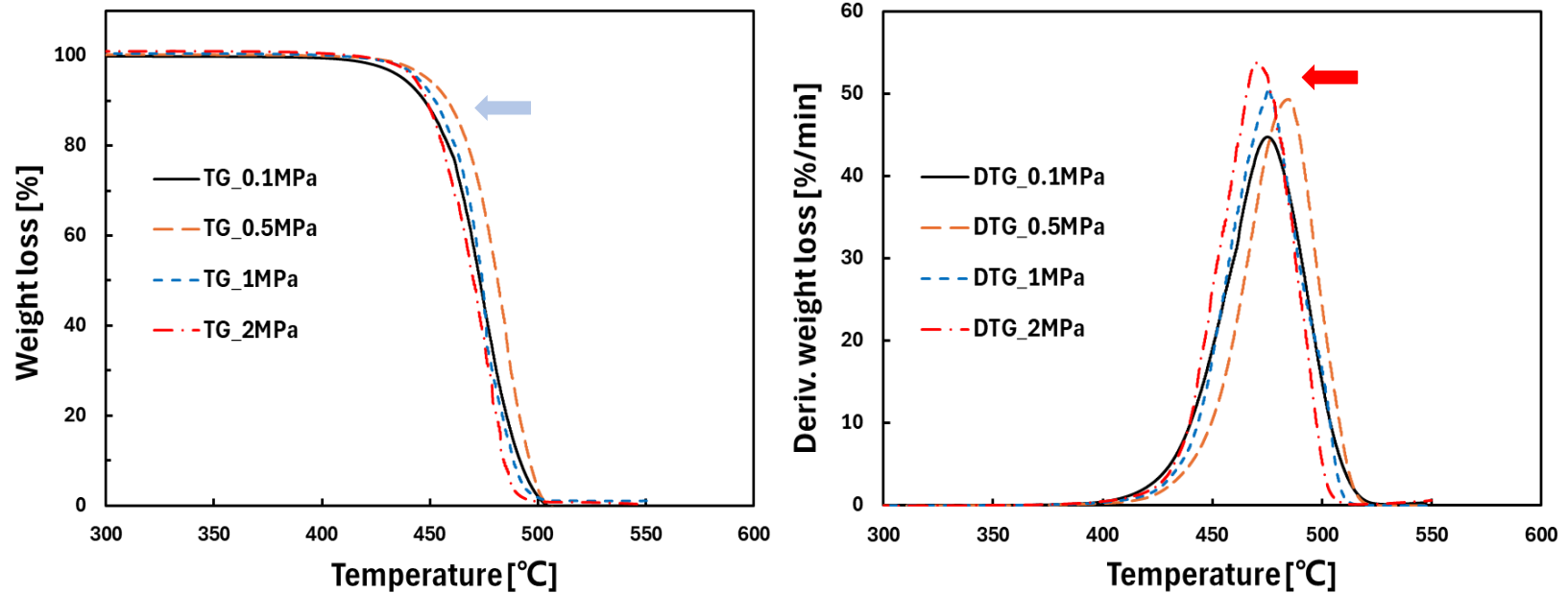
Drying Temperature	40°C for 24h
Weight	25±0.5mg

Catalyst



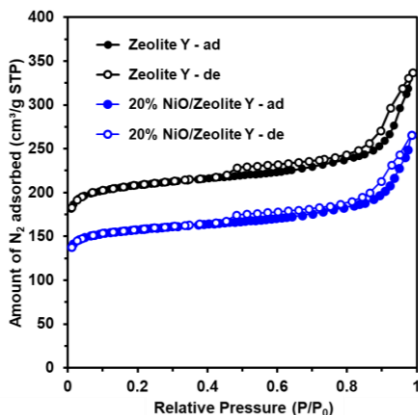
Zeolite-Y & 20% NiO/Zeolite-Y

Thermal weight loss decomposition of polypropylene

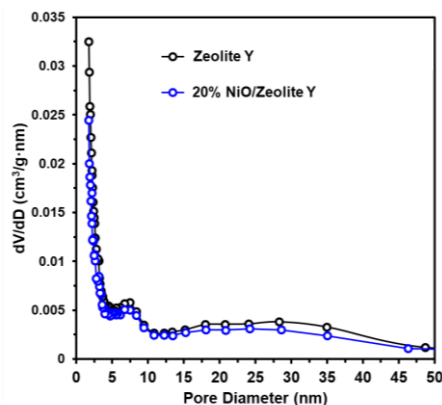


- The onset of pyrolysis was delayed at 0.5MPa due to pressure effects [Primary pyrolysis inhibition]
 - Confirmation that the trend of the graph shifted to the left as the pressure increased
 - As the pressure increases(>0.5MPa), pyrolysis proceeds more rapidly [Promotion of Secondary pyrolysis]
- **Expected increase in Hydrogen production**

Catalyst characteristics



BET analysis result

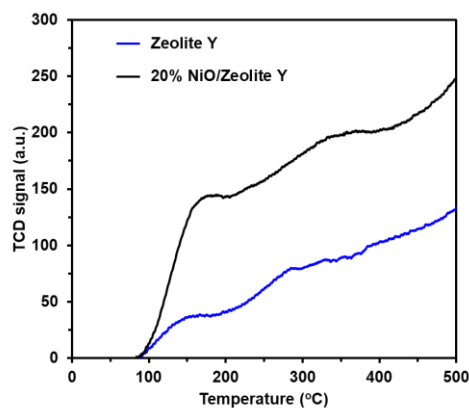


BJH pore-size distribution

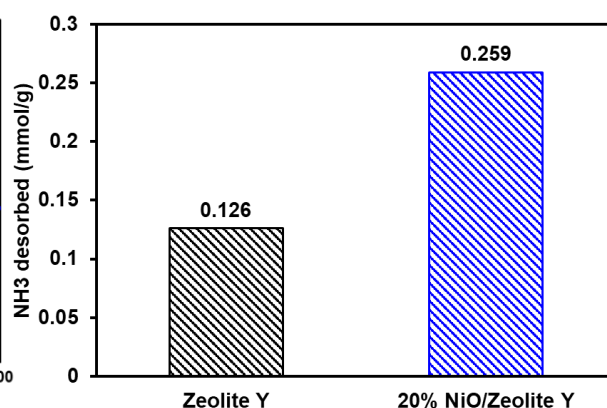
Catalyst	S_{BET} (m^2/g)	V_{total} (cm^3/g)	Pore size (cm^3/g)
Zeolite-Y	704	0.52	1.71
20% NiO/Zeolite-Y	554	0.41	1.70

Slightly lower surface area, but improved catalytic potential:

- Ni is finely dispersed in micropores, promoting active-site accessibility



NH₃-TPD profiles



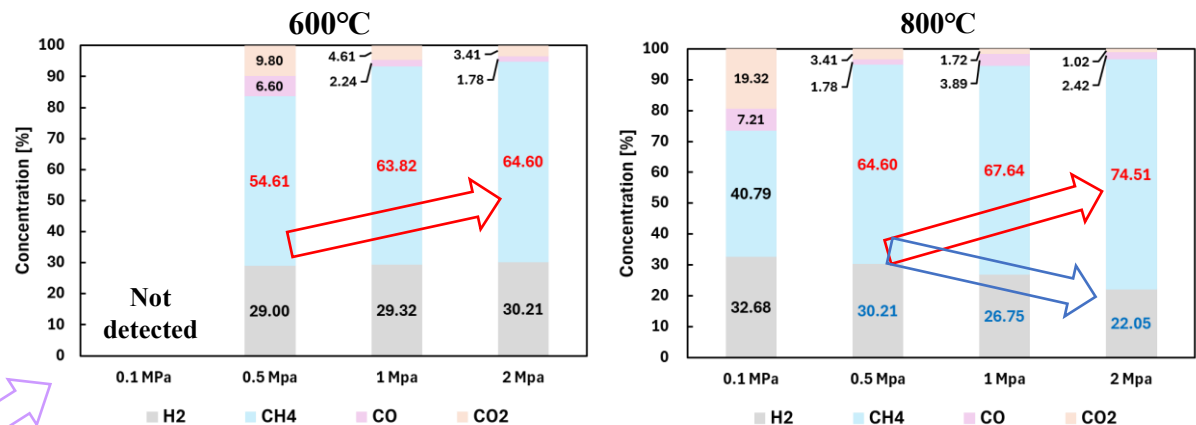
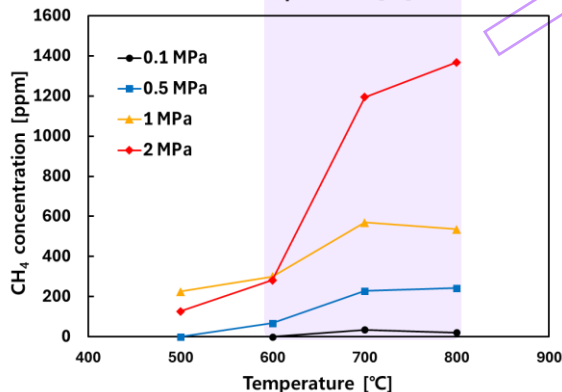
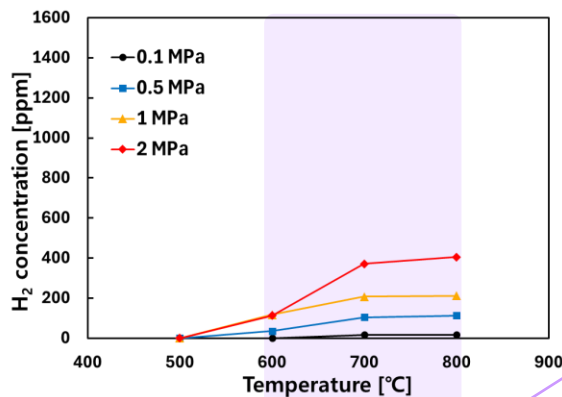
Total NH₃ desorption amounts

20% NiO/Zeolite-Y exhibits enhanced catalytic features for hydrogen production:

- Stronger acid sites confirmed by increased NH₃ desorption and high-temperature peaks
- Improved acid site density despite reduced surface area
- NiO loading promotes active metal-support interaction

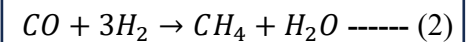
Gas composition of PP (Non-catalyst)

Non-catalyst



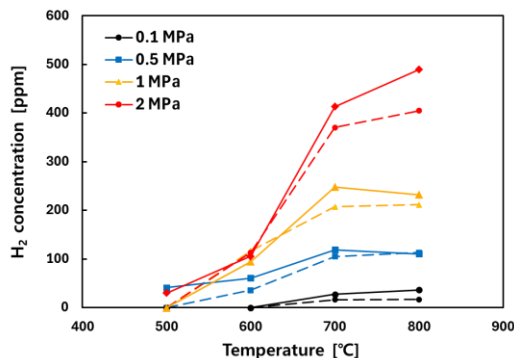
Gas composition analysis during high-pressure pyrolysis of polypropylene [%]

- As the pressure increases, both **H₂** and **CH₄** are enhanced
(Enhanced secondary pyrolysis)
- At early reaction stage (600°C), **H₂** maintains while **CH₄** increases at high pressure
- At later reaction stage (800°C), **H₂** decreases and **CH₄** increases at high pressure
(Activation of methanation reaction)



Gas composition of PP (Non-catalyst & Zeolite-Y)

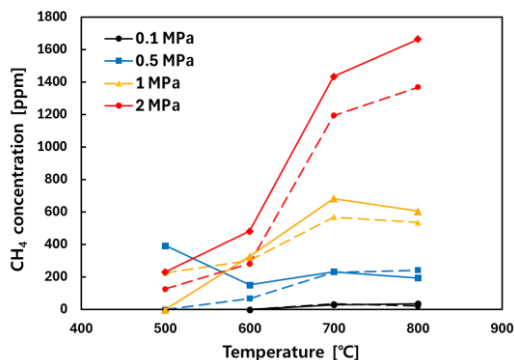
• 점선 : Non-catalyst • 실선 : Zeolite-Y



Non-catalyst			
H ₂ (ppm)	600°C	700°C	800°C
0.1MPa	0	16.41	17.1
0.5MPa	35.96	105.07	113.52
1MPa	117.13	207.28	211.92
2MPa	113.26	370.75	404.82

Zeolite-Y			
H ₂ (ppm)	600°C	700°C	800°C
0.1MPa	0	27.43	36.78
0.5MPa	61.08	119.31	110.78
1MPa	94.97	248.21	232.53
2MPa	106.12	413.36	489.33

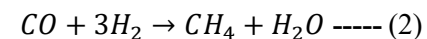
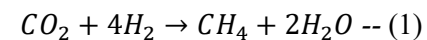
• 점선 : Non-catalyst • 실선 : Zeolite-Y



Non-catalyst			
CH ₄ (ppm)	600°C	700°C	800°C
0.1MPa	0	34.37	21.34
0.5MPa	67.72	228.67	242.77
1MPa	300.49	569.09	535.84
2MPa	281.29	1193.97	1368.14

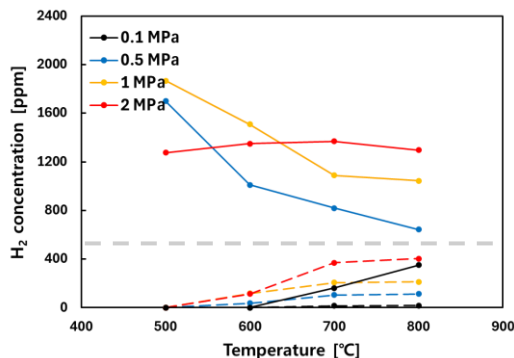
Zeolite-Y			
CH ₄ (ppm)	600°C	700°C	800°C
0.1MPa	0	29.45	36.45
0.5MPa	151.67	233.06	194.48
1MPa	325.88	683.29	604.73
2MPa	481.48	1434.48	1664.05

- Both **H₂** and **CH₄** **increased** as reaction time and pressure were raised
- Catalytic reaction activated conversion (Oil → Syngas)
- **CH₄** production **increased** under high pressure and high temperature due to **methanation** reaction



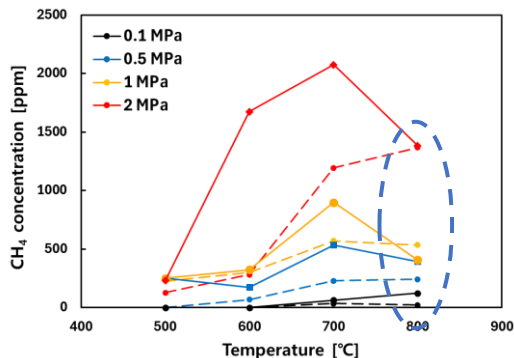
Gas composition of PP (Non-catalyst & NiO/Zeolite-Y)

• 점선 : Non-catalyst • 실선 : NiO/Zeolite-Y



Non-catalyst				NiO/Zeolite-Y			
H ₂ (ppm)	600°C	700°C	800°C	H ₂ (ppm)	600°C	700°C	800°C
0.1MPa	0	16.41	17.1	0.1MPa	0	162.47	350.47
0.5MPa	35.96	105.07	113.52	0.5MPa	1011.10	819.23	642.74
1MPa	117.13	207.28	211.92	1MPa	1510.08	1089.49	1045.49
2MPa	113.26	370.75	404.82	2MPa	1349.48	1369.13	1297.01

• 점선 : Non-catalyst • 실선 : NiO/Zeolite-Y

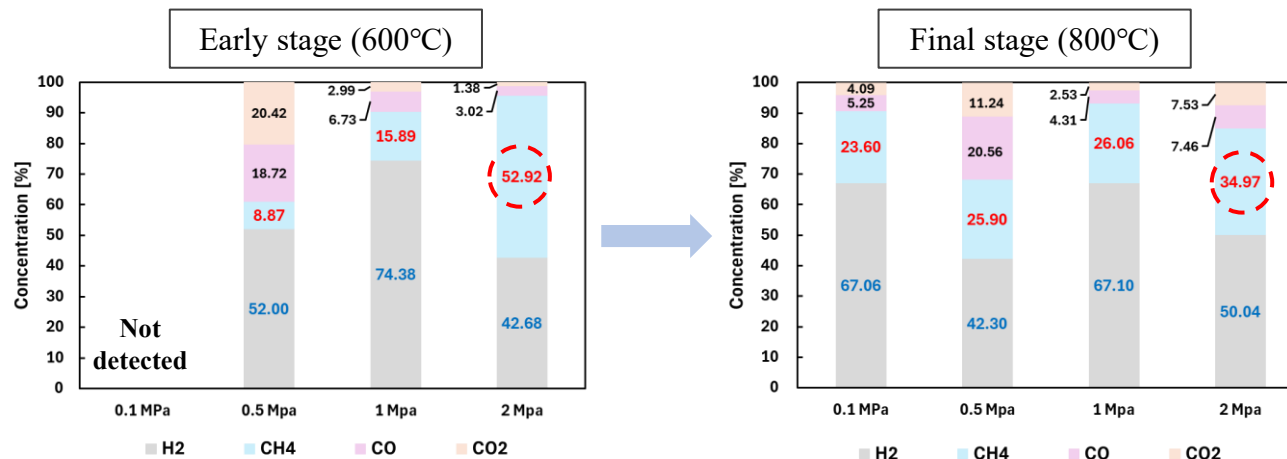


Non-catalyst				NiO/Zeolite-Y			
CH ₄ (ppm)	600°C	700°C	800°C	H ₂ (ppm)	600°C	700°C	800°C
0.1MPa	0	34.37	21.34	0.1MPa	0	63.08	123.31
0.5MPa	67.72	228.67	242.77	0.5MPa	172.40	534.61	393.49
1MPa	300.49	569.09	535.84	1MPa	322.63	897.75	406.09
2MPa	281.29	1193.97	1368.14	2MPa	1673.42	2076.03	1383.90

- H₂ yield significantly **increased** compared to the case without catalyst
- CH₄ concentration exhibited a **declining trend** at 800°C
- Suppression of the methanation reaction (1) Thermal decomposition of CH₄
(2) Reverse Methanation reaction

Gas composition of PP (Non-catalyst & NiO/Zeolite-Y)

NiO/Zeolite-Y

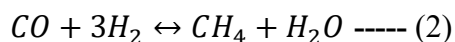


(1) Thermal decomposition of CH_4 (52.92% $\rightarrow$ 34.97%)

- CH_4 decomposed to $\text{H}_2/\text{CO}/\text{CO}_2$ at 800°C (cracking and reforming reaction)
 $\rightarrow \text{H}_2, \text{CO}, \text{CO}_2$ concentration increase

(2) Reverse methanation reaction

- The catalyst strongly promotes the dominance of the **reverse methanation** reaction at high temperature



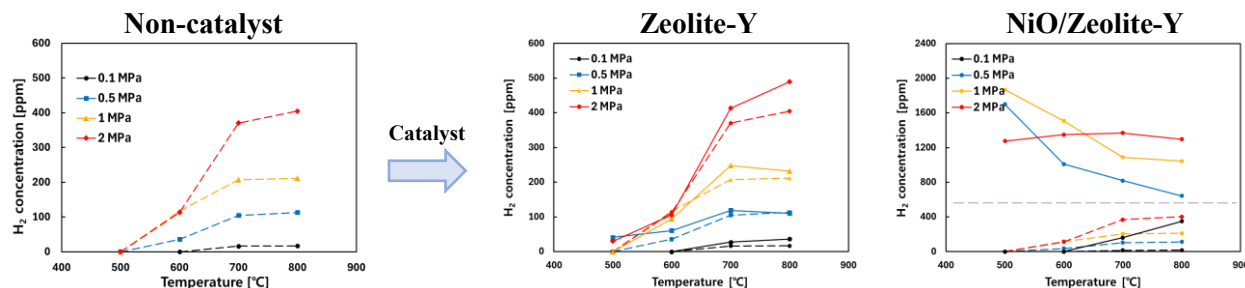
$\rightarrow \text{CO}$ (3.02% $\rightarrow$ 7.46%), CO_2 (1.38% $\rightarrow$ 7.53%)

NiO/Zeolite-Y

- promoting active-site accessibility
- Improved acid site density
- NiO promotes active interaction

Conclusion

- The pyrolysis of polypropylene
 - Secondary pyrolysis was enhanced under high-pressure conditions
 - Increased pyrolysis reactivity results in higher gas yield



Gas concentration

(1) Non-catalyst Case

- As pressure increases, both H_2 and CH_4 increase
- Under high-temperature & pressure, H_2 decreased while CH_4 increased via the methanation reaction

(2) Zeolite-Y Case

- Due to the catalytic reaction, the conversion of oil to gas was enhanced

(3) NiO/Zeolite-Y Case

- H_2 yield significantly increased compared to the case without catalyst
- The reverse methanation reaction becomes dominant at high temperature

The researcher would like to thank the following people who have assisted me

- Prof. Chung-Hwan Jeon (Supervisor, PCERI), PNU
- Lab member : Hyeong-Bin Moon
- Advisor : Ph.D. Jae-Hun Yang (University of Newcastle)
- This research was supported by a grant from the National Research Foundation of Korea (NRF) grant funded by the Korean government (MSIT) (Grant No.2020R1A5A8018822).

**Thank you
Any Questions?**

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